Mood Keepers

Story and Design Roles · Digit7 Jam 2026 · Design phase 14–17 October

The story

Beginning

A teenage girl loves drawing. She enters a school art contest and loses. That night, she tears up her drawing and says, *"I don't want to feel anything anymore."*

Her feelings turn into small glowing creatures called **Moodlings** and run away to the **Night Side**, a dream version of places from her life. Her room turns grey, and she falls asleep.

Her **pet cat** can see feelings. While the girl sleeps, the cat goes to bring them back. The cat never hurts them. It catches them gently, and each one follows the cat as a small coloured light.

> *The player names the girl and the cat.*

The night (7 chapters)

Chapter	Time	Place	What happens
1	9:00 PM	School	Frustrated and Nervous run around the art room.
2	10:30 PM	School	Jealous appears at the winners' wall and steals the cat's lights.
3	12:00 AM	Park	Lonely and Shy hide in the dark.
4	1:30 AM	Park	Frustrated follows them, and the park gets busy.
5	3:00 AM	Lighting festival	Excited bounces between the lamps. Lonely hides in the crowd.
6	4:30 AM	Lakeside	Calm floats on the water. Nervous worries about tomorrow.
7	5:30 AM	Lakeside, then all places	All the feelings join into one big **Overwhelmed**. The cat calms it down and brings every feeling back.

After each chapter: the cat gives the lights back to the sleeping girl. Part of her room gets its colour back, and she looks a little happier in her sleep.

Ending: at sunrise, the girl wakes up. Her room is full of colour, her drawing is fixed, and her best friend has sent a message: *"Art club tomorrow?"* She starts a new drawing of her cat.

Message: all feelings, even hard ones, are part of us. We don't throw them away. We bring them home.

Opening pictures

#	Picture	Text
1	The girl looks at the contest results. Her drawing didn't win.	*"She lost the art contest."*
2	At night, she tears up her drawing.	*"I don't want to feel anything anymore."*
3	Her feelings fly out of the window as little glowing lights. Her room turns grey.	*"Her feelings ran away."*
4	She sleeps. Her cat watches the lights go.	*"Only her cat saw them."*

Then the player names the girl and the cat, and Chapter 1 starts. About 20 seconds, with a **Skip** button.

The 7 Moodlings

Moodling	Colour	How to catch it	What it fixes in her room
Frustrated	Red	Dodge its charge, then pounce while it's dizzy	The torn drawing
Nervous	Purple	Move slowly and sneak up	Her papers
Lonely	Blue	Find it with Night eyes, then sit still	Her phone message
Excited	Yellow	Pounce at the top of its jump	Her sketchbook and fairy lights
Calm	Green	Walk beside it	Her plant
Shy	Pink	Stop moving when it looks back	Her curtains
Jealous	Orange	Chase it to get your lights back	The winner's poster becomes her "well done" note

Design roles (14–17 October)

Role 1: Girl and cat

- **The cat:**
  - 4 colours the player can choose: golden, silver, black, calico
  - 8 movements: stand, walk, sneak, run, jump, pounce, get hit, sleep
- **The girl:**
  - Sleeping poses that look happier after each chapter
  - One waking-up pose
- **4 opening pictures** (see "Opening pictures" above)
- **Screen sketches:** choosing the cat's colour, and naming the girl and the cat

Role 2: Places and backgrounds

- **4 places**, each with 2–3 layers for depth:
  - School: red and purple
  - Park: blue
  - Lighting festival: yellow, with the pagoda only far in the background
  - Lakeside at dawn: green
- **The sky** gets lighter with each chapter, until sunrise.
- **The girl's room:** grey at the start, then 7 changes, then full colour.
- **Rule:** Moodlings must always be easy to see against the background.

Role 3: Barriers and hiding places

- **Every place:** things to climb and jump on, and barriers that make Frustrated's charge miss.
- **For each Moodling:**
  - Lonely: at least 6 hiding spots
  - Shy: places to hide and peek out
  - Jealous: open space to chase it
  - Excited: lantern strings to bounce on
- **A map plan for each of the 7 chapters**, showing where the cat starts and where Moodlings appear.
- **A map plan for the 3 parts of the final chapter.**

Role 4: Moodling natures

- **The final look** of all 7 Moodlings, plus the Golden one
- **2–3 rare versions** of each, for the Mood Book
- **For each Moodling:** its personality, how it moves, its warning sign, how it gets caught
- **Overwhelmed:** the big final creature, in 3 parts
- **Small movements:** floating, warning, getting caught, following as a light

Schedule

Day	Work
14 Oct	Agree on the art style, then do rough sketches
15 Oct	Final girl and cat, and the first places
16 Oct	Cat movements, the other places, chapter maps 5–7, Shy, Jealous and Overwhelmed
17 Oct	Review everything together, fix problems, then **lock the designs**